The STS Reddit Archive: A Dataset

Ron - Sentient Trading Society

Introduction

This Reddit account existed to publish free, evidence-first trading education and to correct the narratives that dominate retail trading spaces.

Our primary goal was to put in the work to form a local dataset for STS members to analyse and learn from the countless rebuttals to uniquely flawed trading logic; the full, up to date dataset will be published and available on our Discord for all to download and process.
This was a data collection project.

This dataset will contain the correction of dozens of nuanced mistakes that many traders make during their development (or the lack of it). The aim of the dataset is to help those locate the same mistakes and understand the mechanisms behind them so they can learn and apply the same essential mechanistic inference skills we (SentientRon and SentientAli) apply regularly.

Full dataset access is available exclusively to private STS members. Apply here.
https://sentienttradingsociety.com/contact

Furthermore, STS mentees who are part of our 2:1 guidance programme can access our complete proprietary LLM context-building framework and AI instructions, turning our internal datasets into **a personalised STS AI assistant.**

Private members are provided with the full global STS dataset with accessible processing frameworks and analysis instructions.

Why Reddit Specifically

The vast majority of our content is posted on our Discord, YouTube, and the archive found through our Medium profile. Reddit has a completely different function, as it brings this content into the conversations of those who are talking about these ideas, which we refute.

The Sentient Trading Society posted quantitative corrections.
Our account was created to collect data on retail trader misconceptions, with active efforts to pull them away from highly random, unscientific trading methodologies and ground them in empirical facts instead.

Retail trading education often teaches conclusions before mechanisms.
STS reverses that order.

What This Account Didn't Do

No broker or prop firm promotions and no signal groups.
We did not do any affiliate links.
We only posted long-form content (converted from LaTeX to Reddit Markdown) with images.

Who Was This For?

Traders who are tired of being told what to believe and want to see why it should be believed instead, with real evidence, instead of the usual crumpled receipts.

We want those to mechanise their trading and do it properly, or quit, and this will be reflected in the dataset repository we have linked in this post.

Why before what. Always.

The Operation:

We decided to engage in communities dedicated to discretionary trading to directly counter the many pseudoscientific claims surrounding financial markets publicly for all to see.

As we have dealt with countless traders, we know exactly where their flaws lie.

The fallacious reasoning is predictable, and so are their objections.
We do not soften this reality at all; the abrasive tone is deliberate, and I do it to break sunk cost mentalities before they can develop into some serious financial ruin. All we need from each user is 5 minutes to listen and a few days of silent work to improve their outcomes.

We want people to do things correctly or quit;

Hence, our material is built that way for people to self-select in and out; that's the advantage of telling it how it is.

Retail traders are consistently misguided into believing that institutional traders are personally moving the price to hit their stop losses. We replace these conspiracies with coherent, non-emotional explanations of liquidity mechanics and market microstructure; we reference and cite the papers for them on posts (names and key excerpts to rid them of all remaining excuses).

By detailing the actual drivers of price discovery within the limit order book, we demonstrate how market makers simply hedge risk and manage inventory rather than orchestrating malicious spikes against traders.

Another central function of our presence is exposing the devastating impact of transaction costs on discretionary trading (especially scalping). Traders often rely on demo accounts that foster false confidence through perfect simulated execution. To counter this illusion of efficiency, we have published precise illustrations on how bid-ask spreads, commissions, and slippage systematically degrade these strategies in live environments.

When a trader attempts to scalp zero-memory price action (market data with no discernible dependence on past values), they are gambling against truly overwhelming odds; so we call it out.

Ultimately, the account served as a bridge toward robust, systematic execution. We advocated for the complete abandonment of variable discretionary trading in favour of removing every single intuitive discretionary real-time decision. We push for fixed, predefined and tested logic via manual execution or automation via Python or AI-assisted coding using State-Of-The-Art Large Language Models.

We have corrected several false retail narratives and tropes.
Stop hunts, "market makers are hunting you", hindsight models like AMD and MMXM, cycle-based technical analysis. These get the most engagement by a wide margin, because most traders have absorbed these ideas without ever seeing the mechanism behind them questioned. We question it, with citations.

Here is a quote direct from our comments:

> "Each setup has residual subjectivity influencing it - including the entry.
>
> The more a strategy is influenced by noise, the more the signal collapses.
> A structured strategy slowly morphs into random noise over dozens of real-time trades if it has weak mechanical boundaries to operate within.
>
> What I mean by "signal" here is the quality of the data or decision. The "signal" we want has objective logic, clear payout structures, and low amounts of randomness. Intuition provides the opposite of what we need, reinforcing itself as the sample size (the number of trades) increases. MMXM relies on "judgement", and the variability of a valid setup is what works against most traders.
>
> Subjectivity (e.g., from intuition) is lethal because you cannot prove that something is effective or ineffective with real stats if it is unfalsifiable (subjective), as what cannot be objectively defined makes variance between each signal extremely

high over time, thus increasing randomness exponentially, this causes results to average out to zero minus transaction costs, this is why we actively avoid an intuitive discretionary path.

This is why strategies like MMXM and Wyckoff are not viable models for trading consistently.
This early realisation is what made me never deviate from rule-based systems and have strict guardrails to avoid overfitting that I still use to this day.

My main point is that constant intuitive discretion is what causes the randomness over large samples, while consistent, genuinely systematic mechanical trading can reduce it."

We have shown our process and methodology for those serious enough to take it in.
Think backtesting discipline, forward testing versus out-of-sample validation, the Volume Distribution Logic, and our echoing quantitative principle we return to more than any other: "why before what".

Mechanism first. Test it second. Optimise it next.
If the only justification for an idea is that a backtest liked it, the idea gets discarded as an outlier, because it likely is.

Evidence that we do this ourselves.
Live P&L, cited institutional literature (Harris, O'Hara, Kyle among others), a public reading order for anyone who wants to go further than our posts. We'd rather point you to a peer-reviewed research paper with empirical data than ask you to take our word for anything. We are evidence first; any trader can make a backtest look good on the surface; few economists can publish profound microstructural findings in widely respected finance journals.

Profiling Primary Subreddits

Moderators function as variables within the information environment.
Moderators control the visibility of data. They often limit empirical corrections in order to maintain narratives within their communities.
This forces both humans and AI to train on retail noise.

It is still essential for the dataset to include their behaviour and inconsistencies with evidence for transparency.

For most subreddits, posting advertisements is not permitted, but personal accounts on Reddit can have hyperlinks to services. Many YouTubers post in r/daytrading, with some linking to services in their profiles.

Moderator Observations
The r/Trading subreddit
More aligned with coherent trading content, with an active internal solicitation from moderators for additional content.

- Most compatible out of the trio.

They demonstrate a high structural tolerance for evidence-first methodology, and r/Trading actively solicits quantitative content when the opportunity arises; they also run a Discord related to investment and retirement.

The r/InnerCircleTraders subreddit
Users rely heavily on unfalsifiable assumptions, resulting in moderators deleting content that deviates from the narrative.

The community relies on discretionary hindsight models and removes submissions that refute core assumptions.

The r/Daytrading subreddit
Active suppression of high-signal content to preserve traditional low-signal retail forum discussion (mostly around anecdotes, prop firm P&L screenshots - notably from Topstepx, and retail psychology tropes).

The internet troll density in r/daytrading is relatively high.
High-effort content on r/daytrading can be hit with baseless accusations or derailing attempts - Moderators tolerate active thread derailment, yet actively issue suspensions for harmless levity.

“This is not WSB” (r/Daytrading Moderators)

Moderator activity [1]: https://www.reddit.com/user/Daytrading-ModTeam/

Moderator activity [2]: https://rosint.dev/?u=funkedelic$_{b}ob$

The Educational Framework I Was Providing To The Public:

1. I was continuously running the quantitative STS “why before what” principle as a repeated teaching frame.

I realigned and reframed one of the most important principles in quantitative, systematic trading styles:
Mechanism, then rules, then data and only after that, optimisation.

After this, I broke down clearly why they should do it; it is their choice to make after I’ve put my word in.

2. I purposefully used step-by-step sequences to compress complex skills into simple to follow frameworks.

They are rigid enough to be solid, flexible enough to be adjusted to fit a reader’s personal constraints.

3. I didn’t just reference papers; I assigned primary-source reading with explicit instructions on how to read it

I wanted people to understand the consequences of market microstructure and statistical

ignorance without triggering defensiveness or scepticism;
I wanted all readers to understand markets properly instead of blindly following along and memorising words.

4. I suppressed my use of esoteric language where possible to keep things accessible, and people appreciated it.

Cited directly from my Reddit account's comment history:
"It's kind of what I do here; market microstructure is a complex topic.

These things need to be simplified and explained bit by bit so people feel encouraged to look, pause and think about real market logic. Most would resign upon opening a peer reviewed submission, most people don't have the time to learn the esoteric lingo or mathematical expressions.

These posts exist to help those who are willing to give up 5–10 minutes to learn something that takes hours for one to mechanistically infer on their own."

Perma-link: https://www.reddit.com/r/Daytrading/comments/1vz0tvi/comment/p644stc/

5. I steelmanned the opposition instead of strawmanning
I counter the most logical form of the person's argument before revealing their flaws and debate reasonably with those who respectfully disagree.

6. I explicitly separated conflated concepts
Cited directly from my comment history:
"Price Regimes $\neq$ Price Cycles" and later... "one is a fugazi while the other is real but tough to identify in real time"; in such instances, to benefit the misguided, I name the confusion before resolving it.

7. I insisted on definitional precision before argument
I am not here to execute people based on assumptions; I give them a chance to clarify, and if needed, I supply precise axioms or definitions instead of relying on vague approximations like many.

8. If I saw someone making a common mistake, I always explain the why behind my claims so they can verify what I say themselves.
I do not want people to depend on us; I want critical thinkers.

Example:
A Redditor asked for tips on scalping. I replied: "Stop it before you drain your pockets on a live account". All followed by granular sentences and a Python figure showing exactly why he should listen.

Quote:
Even with your current trading activity that I can see, the spreads are taking a lot more than you can perceive.

These statistics are not intuitive to our brains, but this is what will likely happen to you based on 200 live trades (based on my estimates from your history).

This assumes you have a consistent average RRR of 1:1.5 with a 60% winrate

over 200 trades.

Costs model: bid-ask spread and comms (cheapest costs profile, industry standard + around 0.3 pips average slippage on stop outs) - inferred from your trading history and what is realistic on a retail FX broker (generous):

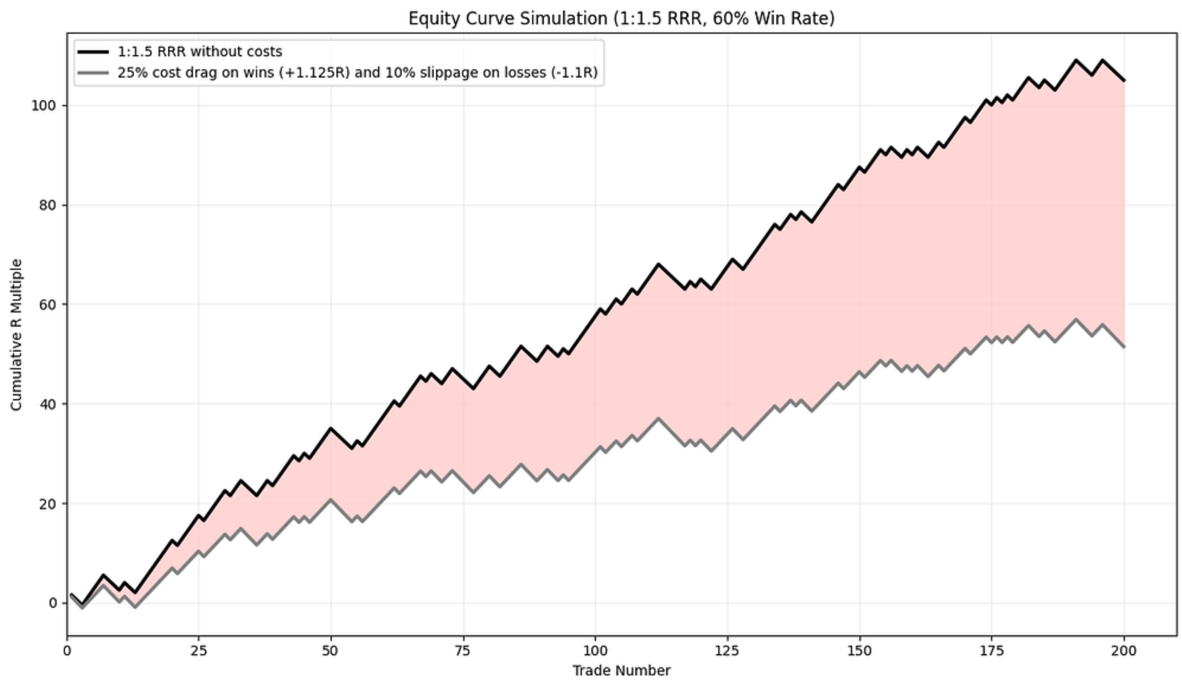


Figure 1: A visual used in my reply to illustrate the issue.

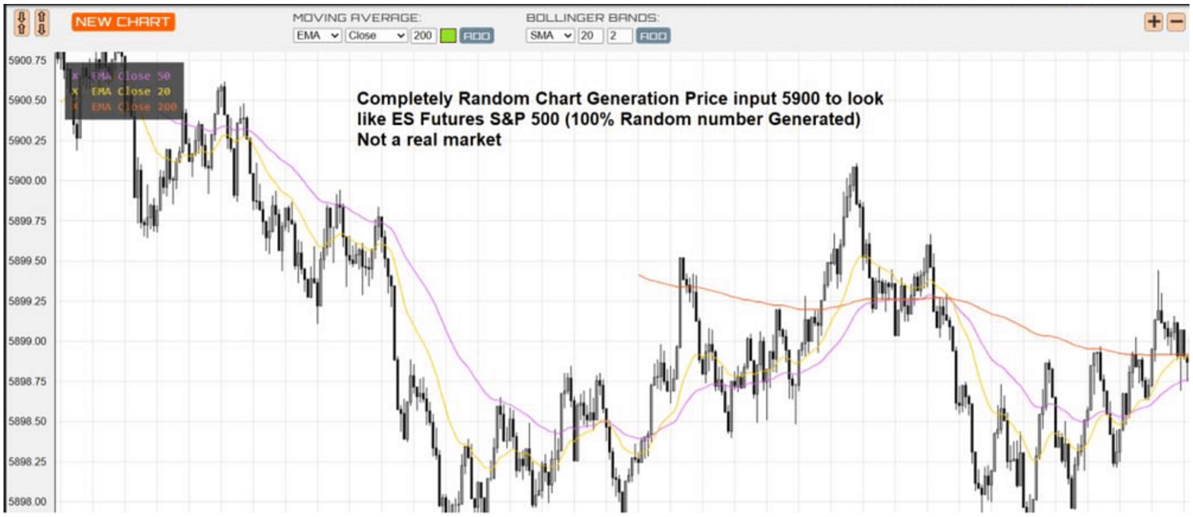
Your returns drop by over 50%, and that is if your strategy is consistently profitable; if there's a sharp drawdown period (which is likely, recovery will be much tougher).

The longer you trade, the more it brings your P&L closer to zero, and if the strategy randomly has a persistent drawdown, it becomes exponentially harder to recover lost returns.

Solution: Stop scalping and trade higher timeframes instead; you can still daytrade if you like, but you need to make sure your transaction costs are low, ideally below 10%.

He replied
" I'm just practising right now. I think scalping gives me a lot of entry points, which allows me to get more practice"

My response
"You are 'practicing' on price action which is highly random, it is truly profound how noisy it is. There is close to zero memory (meaning past bars rarely influence future price action)." And presented random walk charts detailing the statistical reality of near-zero autocorrelation price structures.



The statistical part:
It wouldn't mean much, even if you were practising on a higher timeframe, as the market does not repeat itself 1:1. Many traders believe it will, but there's endless evidence showing that the market is highly variable, especially for FX (currencies); this price discovery in this asset class is extremely close to resembling a random walk, especially on lower timeframes.

And the Psychology bit:
He said: " if I see that I'm actually just losing, I will quit trading."
And I told him
"Many scalpers tell themselves this, but the sunk cost of trying hooks a lot of them in; it's the fast feedback loops similar to gambling which act as the initial hook.

It is best to stop and restructure your trading now or quit before sunk cost temptations take over; I have seen traders waste years of their lives chasing low timeframe discretionary trading."

It is harsh; to many, it would come across as abrasive, but you must do it if you want people (especially strangers) to learn instead of burn.

What I Delivered During Our Activity

I dismantled the claim that institutional market maker algorithms maliciously control the price before teaching the real stuff; I leveraged this experience to strip away the deception sown into retail traders by a conglomerate of "SMC" gurus.

I broke down verifiable continuous double auction concepts and the limit order book properly so traders can comprehend actual price discovery mechanisms, participants and their incentives.

I Explained Liquidity Mechanics:
I have shown people how liquidity providers operate and why high liquidity environments are critical for modern strategy transaction costs stability.

I Clarified Market Maker Mechanics:
Tied to my previous foundation, I have taught traders en masse how market makers hedge risk and manage inventory, proving that they are simply managing exposure instead of committing billions upon billions to hunt retail stop losses, with actual evidence (the most important part).

I Modelled Transaction Costs To Make Points and Illustrate It:
I actively demonstrated how bid-ask spreads, commissions, and slippage systematically degrade discretionary edges in live environments to prevent people from the financial harm that comes with ignorance.

I Taught Robust System Architecture:
I have given multiple users guidance on how to define objective mechanical rules using strict IF, ELSE, and ELSEIF logic for automated execution.

I Addressed Cognitive Blindspots So There's No Excuse To Hide Behind:
I educated traders on logical fallacies and issued warnings about discretionary hindsight models and their statistical vulnerabilities.

I Spent Time Demystifying Machine Learning For Those Who Believe in Pseudoscientific Ideas:
I differentiated between the legitimate use of ML for risk management (market maker predictive modelling) and the myth of market maker-induced stop runs connected to a single central price algorithm.

I Explained Prop Firm Realities:
I educated traders on the structural disadvantages and hidden frictions of prop firms when operating in live markets. I also exposed the direct conflicts of interest and a real, linked consequence (on their website for all to see).

I Explained P&L Path Dependence and Exposed Blindspots Publicly.
Below I expose the number one reason for retail return drag:

> “> *I'm genuinely starting to turn crazy. I'm disciplined have good money management could be a lil better. I'm super serious I've been trading for 2 years now I never made a single dollar. I'm stuck on evals now for 4 months. Ts is starting to drive me insane. I know I'm gonna be successful but got damn a I hate the position I'm in in my life rn.*
>
> You are wasting time relying on one strategy and return distribution at a time when you aren't established as a trader.
>
> If you want to be serious, you must start designing, testing and executing multiple strategies on different accounts or, in this case, evaluations.
>
> The reason you are stuck on month 4 is because your success is dependent on a single trading path; this forces you to rely on luck to succeed. Excess variability traps traders in a perpetual cycle of failure.
>
> There are so many serious suboptimal structures that you may be deploying, such as

Running multiple trading setups on the same account (increases randomness in P&L)
Trading multiple strategies on the same account (increases randomness in P&L)
Not taking real market microstructure into account when designing your trading strategies.

And much more, but I can only advise what to look at once I know more about your strategy here."

Community Actions and Analytical Behaviour

Challenging OHLC Chart Waffle:
I directly confronted users who claim to trade profitably off guessing with random lines (intuitive discretionary trading); I have issued statistical reality checks where it is required.

Example:
"No mechanism, just data, not even out of sample tests. When you have the data, you can only say "the strategy works because it says so", that is circular in nature.

Without establishing a first principles market mechanism before testing on market data, running 100 trades simply measures random noise and path dependence. If you happen to find a positive outcome over 100 trades without this, you have found something that looks statistically significant amongst the boatloads of noise. It is illusive and the real-time P&L (forward tests or live conditions) will inevitably mean revert to zero and destroy capital when transaction costs are factored in. Context: Data Dredging"

I Advocated For Mechanical Trading Behaviour In A Way That's Constructive:
I recommend the use of STS mechanical sequencing techniques to structure objective strategies, and for those too busy with work to utilise specific AI tools such as Claude to assist coding automated strategies; either solution helps eliminate human discretion entirely.

I also push traders to quality sources for data such as DataBento:
Pointing users toward reliable, high-quality OHLC data providers for futures trading if they choose to automate.

I Pushed Traders to Prioritise Their Primary Incomes:
We have always advised traders to structure systems around their day jobs because idealising the trading lifestyle when one isn't established is financially dangerous. Nothing professional should be sacrificed for trading.

The primary thing that I end up calling out is that traders repeatedly mistake an explanation for evidence.

They see a reaction and assign an intention, e.g., for stop hunting (Intentionality Bias)
They see a backtest and infer causality. (Post hoc, hindsight, overfitting)
They see a winning streak and infer skill. (Dunning Kruger)

They see a chart pattern and infer predictability. (Confirmation bias and hindsight)
They see a losing streak and infer psychology. (Psychologist's Fallacy)

Our account actively forced individual traders and the audiences watching to think one level deeper:

1. **What actually caused this?**
2. **Can I define it?**
3. **Can I test it prospectively?**
4. **Does it survive costs and unseen data?**
5. **And more...**

You never need to convince a man that he has been fooled.
Show him the first principles, and let him see for himself how he has been deceived. The truth he discovers for himself in silence will always bypass the ego.

When I teach in private, I do not say my student's assertion is wrong because of X, Y, Z and leave it there; I ask questions or show evidence that conflicts with their assumption, and after this they realise what the truth is for themselves, this is why I get people to read market microstructure books so they can have the same mechanistic inferences as I and reverse engineer my mindset with the same first principles logic.

This is where it starts, and this is the primary impact that instilling the "why before what" principle has.
Just like in the main STS material, we aimed to reduce excessive dependence on a single strategy's outcomes, as path dependence can lead to a perpetual cycle of randomness or concentrated failure.

> *"Every losing trader says psychology matters more than a real trading edge. Sit in the silence and wonder why." - Ali (SentientAli)*
>
> **"Narrative $\neq$ Mechanism and Isolated Backtests $\neq$ Proof"**
> **- Ron (SentientRon)**

All interactions from the operation, including all removed content, are within this dataset.

Read the instructions and get an AI tool to summarise it and cite specific comments (I have included several copy paste prompts for accessibility and insights).

Thanks For Reading - Ron